FOR THE PERSON PLAYING THE INTERVIEWER

You don't need to know anything about consulting.

This binder gives you everything a real interviewer has: what to say, what information to hand over and when, what a good answer sounds like, and how to score it. Your partner does the thinking. You hold the facts and keep the clock.

What a case interview is, in 30 seconds

Consulting firms test candidates with a short business puzzle, called a **case**. You read out a client's problem, for example "a hot dog stand is losing money, why?". The candidate has to ask good questions, organize the problem, do some math out loud, and end with a clear recommendation. It's a test of **how they think**, not of business trivia.

Your job, in one line each

- **Read** the blue *Say* lines out loud, word for word if you like.
- **Answer** questions using the *If they ask* tables. Anything not on the list: "Not important for this case, make an assumption."
- **Hold back** the yellow *Give* boxes until the moment described. Never volunteer data early.
- **Tick** the *Listen for* boxes as you hear them. That is your evidence for scoring.
- **Never show** the green *Answer key*. It's for you to check the candidate's numbers.
- **Score** at the end with the rubric, then give feedback: 2 strengths, 2 things to fix.

The colors in every case

SAY

Words you read out loud.

GIVE ONLY WHEN…

Data you hand over (read it, or show this box) only when the trigger happens.

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The right numbers and what a strong answer contains.

IF THEY'RE STUCK

Hints in order. Give one, wait 30 seconds, then the next.

Before you start (2 minutes)

- [ ] Pick a case you haven't read with them. Start with an **Easy** one.
- [ ] Read the case once to yourself, start to finish (about 5 minutes).
- [ ] Give the candidate paper, a pen and a calculator-free zone (no phone calculator; real interviews don't allow one).
- [ ] Sit across a table. Start a timer. Aim for 20–25 minutes per case.
- [ ] Keep a straight, friendly face. Real interviewers don't react much.

THE SIX STAGES

Every case follows the same shape

Each case script below walks you through these stages. Knowing the shape helps you notice when the candidate skips one.

1 You read the prompt

Read slowly. A good candidate writes it down and then repeats it back in their own words. If they don't, tick it as missed.

2 They ask clarifying questions

Usually 2–4 questions: about the goal, the client, the market. Answer from the *If they ask* table. More than ~6 questions is too many.

3 They build a framework

They'll ask for a minute or two of silence. Say "Sure, take your time." Then they explain how they'll break the problem into parts (for example "revenue" and "costs"). Compare with the Answer key.

4 Analysis and math

They ask for data, or estimate it themselves. You give the yellow boxes. They calculate out loud. You check against the Answer key.

5 Insight: "so what?"

After each number, a strong candidate says what it means for the client. If they don't, ask: "What does that mean for the client?"

6 Recommendation

You say the closing line. They should give the answer **first**, then 2–3 reasons, then risks and next steps. Under a minute.

Timing guide for a 25-minute case

Stage	Target	If it runs long
Prompt + questions	2–3 min	"Let's get going. What's your approach?"
Framework	2–4 min	"Which part would you look at first?"
Analysis and math	10–15 min	Give the next hint from the script.

Recommendation	1–2 min	"In one sentence: yes or no?"
Your feedback	5 min	Rubric + 2 strengths, 2 fixes.

Golden rules

1. Make them ask

Data comes out only when they ask for it, or when the script says "give if their estimate is way off". Asking for the right data is part of the test.

2. Let them estimate first

Many cases are **candidate-led**: they should make up reasonable numbers first. Only give the real number if theirs is far off (each script says what "far off" means), or if they ask directly.

3. Don't confirm too fast

When they get a number right, say "Okay, keep going." When it's wrong, say "Can you double-check that?" Never tell them the right number until they've tried twice.

4. Silence is fine

When they ask for time, give it: real interviewers wait. Only speak up after about 60 seconds of total silence.

5. Push back once

Once per case, ask "Why?" or "Are you sure?" even when they're right. It tests whether they stay calm and can defend their logic.

6. Hints in order

If they're stuck, use the red hint boxes one at a time. Every hint you give costs a point on "Drive" in the rubric. Note how many you gave.

Phrase bank

They ask for time to think	"Sure, take a minute."
They ask something not in your script	"Good question, but it's not important here. Make a reasonable assumption."
They ask "Is that right?"	"What do you think?" or "Walk me through how you got there."
They're silent for a long time	"Can you walk me through what you're thinking?"
They ramble or go off-track	"Let's focus. What do you need to answer the client's question?"

They finish a calculation and stop	"So what does that mean for the client?"
They made a math mistake	"Can you double-check that last step?"
They ask you to just give the number	"What would you estimate?" (Give it if the script says so.)
Time is running out	"The CEO just walked in. What's your recommendation?"

USE THIS FOR EVERY CASE

Scoring rubric

Score each area from 1 to 5. A 3 means "would probably pass at a first-round interview". Use the ticks from the case script as evidence. Be honest: a generous score doesn't help them.

Area	1–2: Weak	3: Pass	4–5: Strong
Structure	Jumps into numbers with no plan. Framework is a generic list or misses big pieces.	Clear framework with 2–4 parts that fit the case. Some overlap or gaps.	Framework is tailored to this client, has no overlaps or gaps, and is explained in under 2 minutes. Says which part to look at first and why.
Math	Wrong answers, messy, silent working, or needs a calculator.	Correct with maybe one slip they fix themselves. Talks through steps.	Fast, correct, clean units (per day, per year, $M). Rounds sensibly and announces each step out loud.
Business sense	Reports numbers without meaning. Misses the key insight even after hints.	Explains what numbers mean when asked. Finds the insight with one hint.	Says "so what" on their own, sanity-checks results ("that seems high because..."), spots the key insight unprompted.
Communication	Hard to follow, rambles, recommendation is vague or missing.	Clear enough. Recommendation exists but is buried or long.	Answer-first, organized ("three reasons: first..."), confident, under a minute to close.
Drive	Waits for you to lead. Needed 3+ hints.	Mostly leads. Needed 1–2 hints.	Leads the whole case, asks for the right data at the right time, suggests next steps. No hints needed.

Reading the total (out of 25)

- **21–25**: Offer-level. Move to harder cases.
- **16–20**: Solid. Fix the lowest area.
- **11–15**: Getting there. Redo this case type in a few days.

- **5–10**: Practice the basics: frameworks and mental math.

How to give feedback (5 minutes)

1. Ask them first: "How do you think that went?"
2. Share **2 things they did well**, with specific moments ("you caught that the 75–80 age group is 5 years").
3. Share **2 things to fix**, again specific ("you didn't say what the −$100 meant for the owner").
4. Read them the total score and their lowest area.

PLAIN-ENGLISH GLOSSARY

Words the candidate will use

You don't need to use these. It just helps to know what they mean when you hear them.

Framework / structure	Their plan for breaking the problem into parts.
MECE	"Mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive": parts that don't overlap and together cover everything. Interviewers love it.
Revenue	Money coming in. Usually price × quantity sold.
Costs: fixed vs. variable	Fixed costs don't change with sales (rent). Variable costs grow with each unit sold (food in each hot dog).
Profit	Revenue minus costs.
Profit margin	Profit as a % of revenue. $10 profit on $100 revenue = 10% margin.
COGS	"Cost of goods sold": what it costs to make the product itself.
Payback period	Years needed to earn back an investment. Investment ÷ yearly profit.
Breakeven	The point where revenue exactly covers costs (profit = 0).
Market sizing	Estimating how big a market is, e.g. "how much is spent on diapers per year".
Market share	The % of a market one company holds.
Market entry	A case about whether a company should start selling in a new market.
Barriers to entry	Things that make it hard to enter a market: licenses, laws, big competitors.

Cross-selling	Selling a second product to an existing customer.
Sanity check	Asking "does this number make sense?" before moving on.
Price elasticity	How much customers buy less when the price goes up.
"So what?"	What a number means for the client's decision.

PICK ONE

The cases

Start with an Easy case. Read the script once on your own before you begin. Each takes 15–25 minutes plus 5 minutes of feedback.

Diapers in KSA

Market sizing · Easy · ~15 min

Hot Dog Stand

Profitability · Easy · ~15 min

Concert in Riyadh

Profitability · Easy · ~15 min

Billionaire Banker

Market entry · Easy · ~15 min

TV Family Business

Market entry · Medium · ~20 min

Plane Ticket Price

Profitability · Medium · ~20 min

Energy Consumption

Discussion · Hard · ~20 min

KSA Retail Bank

Profitability · Hard · ~25 min

Lebanese Cryptocurrency

Market entry · Medium · ~20 min

Hair Loss Pill

Profitability · Medium · ~20 min

CASE 1 OF 10

Diapers in KSA

Market sizing | Easy | ~15 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

The candidate has to estimate how much money people in Saudi Arabia (KSA) spend on diapers in one year. No data is given up front: they should build the estimate from population numbers.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

About **$2.3 billion per year**. Anything from $1.5B to $3.5B is fine if the logic is sound.

1 Read the prompt

1 min

SAY

"Estimate the market size of diapers in KSA."

"Take a moment. Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Do we include adults / elderly?	"Yes, elderly people are included."
Cloth or disposable?	"Only disposable diapers."
In dollars or number of diapers?	"In dollars: total sales."
Per year?	"Yes, per year."
What's the population / price?	"What would you estimate? (Hold the real numbers for now.)"
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Repeats the question back in their own words
- [ ] Asks whether adults/elderly are included
- [ ] Asks if we mean value ($) or number of diapers

2 Approach

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you approach this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Splits the population by age
- [ ] Includes babies (0–3) AND elderly
- [ ] Uses % of each group who wear diapers
- [ ] Diapers per person per day → per year
- [ ] Multiplies by price per diaper

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

A strong plan: population → people per age → who uses diapers (babies 0–3, some elderly) → how many diapers a day → per year → × price.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who uses diapers?"
2. "Could you split the population into groups?"
3. "Try splitting by age."

3 Population

2 min

SAY

"Okay, let's go with that. What numbers would you use for the population?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: IF THEY ASK, OR IF THEIR POPULATION IS BELOW 25M OR ABOVE 45M, OR THEIR LIFE EXPECTANCY IS BELOW 70 OR ABOVE 85.

Population of KSA: **35 million**. Life expectancy: **80 years**. Assume the same number of people at each age.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Divides population by life expectancy to get people per year of age

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

35M ÷ 80 ≈ **450,000** people per year of age (437,500 rounded).

4 Diaper usage

4–5 min

SAY

"How many diapers are used per day?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK HOW MANY PEOPLE USE DIAPERS OR HOW MANY PER DAY. READ OR SHOW THE TABLE.

Age group	0–1	1–2	2–3	75–80
% using diapers	100%	90%	80%	30%
Diapers per day	10	8	6	4

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Notices 75–80 is FIVE years of people (2.25M), not one
- [ ] Calculates each group separately
- [ ] Gets ~12.6M diapers per day

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Group	People	× use	× per day	= diapers/day
0–1	450k	100%	10	4.5M
1–2	450k	90%	8	3.2M
2–3	450k	80%	6	2.2M
75–80	2.25M	30%	4	2.7M

Total ≈ **`12.6M diapers per day`**.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many years of age are in the 75–80 group?" (if they used 450k for it)
2. "Take it one age group at a time."

5 Price and final number

2 min

SAY

"A pack of 12 diapers costs $6. What's the yearly market size?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Converts to per year (× 365)
- [ ] Price per diaper = $0.50
- [ ] Final ≈ $2.3B, said clearly

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

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12.6M × 365 ≈ 4.6 billion diapers per year
4.6B × $0.50 = $2.3 billion per year
```

6 Close

1 min

SAY

"Great. So what's your final answer?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] States the number first: "about $2.3 billion a year"
- [ ] Mentions the key assumptions
- [ ] Sanity-checks (most of the market is babies)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Example: "The KSA diaper market is about $2.3 billion a year. Babies under 3 make up about 80% of it. The biggest uncertainty is elderly usage, and I assumed an even age split, which understates babies in a young country like KSA."

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 2 OF 10

Hot Dog Stand

Profitability | Easy | ~15 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A small hot dog stand is making less money than before. The candidate has to find out why, then suggest fixes.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

The stand **loses $100 per month**. The clearest fix: it throws away **$200 of expired food** every month, so better stock planning alone makes it profitable.

1 Read the prompt

1–2 min

SAY

"Your client has a hot dog stand that has been experiencing a decline in profitability in the past few months. They want to know what the problem is."

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Where is the stand?	"In Hamra, Beirut."
What do they sell? For how much?	"A standard meal: a hot dog and a drink, for $6."
Who are the competitors? Are they struggling too?	"The direct competitor is Frank's Hot Dog, and they're doing fine. Indirect competitors are Roadster Diner and other restaurants."
Any fixed costs / big investments?	"Ignore fixed costs. The truck has been running for a while."
What's the goal?	"Find out why profits fell and how to fix it."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Repeats the problem back
- [ ] Asks about competitors
- [ ] Asks about prices / what they sell

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you structure this problem?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = revenue − costs
- [ ] Revenue = price × number sold
- [ ] Splits costs into fixed and variable
- [ ] Notes: competitor is fine, so the problem is probably inside our stand

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Profit = Revenue (price × meals) − Costs (fixed + variable). Because Frank's is doing fine, the problem is likely internal.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What is profit made of?"
2. "Where does the stand's money come from, and where does it go?"

3 Revenue

2 min

SAY

"Let's start with revenue. How many meals do you think they sell per day?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: IF THEY ASK, OR ESTIMATE BELOW 5 OR ABOVE 60 MEALS A DAY.

The stand sells **15 meals per day**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] $6 × 15 = $90 per day
- [ ] Converts to monthly: $2,700 (30 days)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

$6 × 15 = $90/day → **$2,700/month**.

4 Costs and profit

3–4 min

SAY

"Now let's look at costs."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT COSTS. READ THE FULL LIST.

- Food cost (COGS): they use a **3× pricing strategy**
- Utilities (gas and electricity): $400/month
- Rent: $800/month
- Labor (1 chef): $500/month
- Expired food: $200/month

If they're confused by "3× pricing": "It means the selling price is three times what the food costs."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Food cost = $6 ÷ 3 = $2 per meal
- [ ] Monthly food = $900
- [ ] Total costs = $2,800
- [ ] Profit = −$100 per month (a loss)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Food: $2 × 15 × 30 = $900
Total: 900 + 400 + 800 + 500 + 200 = $2,800
Profit: 2,700 − 2,800 = −$100 per month
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If the price is 3 times the food cost, what's the food cost per meal?"
2. "Add up all the monthly costs."

5 Ideas to fix it

3–4 min

SAY

"They're losing money. How can they become profitable?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Organizes ideas into 'increase revenue' and 'cut costs'
- [ ] Raise price, but mentions customers may buy less
- [ ] Sell more: marketing, new menu items
- [ ] New income: ads on the truck, delivery, toppings
- [ ] Cut costs without hurting quality
- [ ] Spots the $200 expired food and suggests better ordering/forecasting

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The key insight is the **$200 of expired food**. Ordering based on actual demand removes it and turns −$100 into +$100. A strong candidate also notes that 15 meals a day is low for a busy area like Hamra and asks why Frank's does better.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Look at the cost list again. Is any of it avoidable?"
2. "What does 'expired food' tell you about how they buy stock?"

6 Close

1 min

SAY

"The owner walks in. What do you tell them?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: loses ~$100 a month
- [ ] Main fix: stop wasting $200 of food
- [ ] Then: grow sales / adjust price

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 3 OF 10

Concert in Riyadh

Profitability | Easy | ~15 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

An events company wants to put on a DJ concert in Riyadh. The candidate works out whether it makes money, then what else could go wrong.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Profit of **$15,800** if it sells out ($38,000 revenue – $22,200 costs). Then: licenses, local rules and culture, selling tickets, extra income.

1 Read the prompt

1–2 min

SAY

"Our client is an entertainment company that wants to do a concert in Riyadh with a famous DJ. They've come to us to see if it's a good idea or not."

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What does 'good idea' mean? Profit?	"Mainly: will it make money. Then what else they need to get right."
One concert or a series?	"A single concert."
How do they make money?	"Ticket sales and sponsors. I have numbers when you need them."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks what 'good idea' means (profit? brand?)
- [ ] Asks about revenue sources / ticket prices

2 Framework

2 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue (tickets, sponsors, extras) – costs
- [ ] Mentions feasibility: permits, local rules
- [ ] Mentions demand: can we sell the tickets?

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What would make this concert a success for the client?"

3 Revenue

3 min

SAY

"Let's look at the numbers."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT REVENUE, TICKETS OR SPONSORS.

	VIP	Regular
Tickets	400	600
Price	$50	$20

Sponsor	Amount
EJ Entertainment	$3,000
Sky Events	$2,000
DJDS Events	$1,000

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] VIP $20,000 + Regular $12,000
- [ ] Sponsors $6,000
- [ ] Total $38,000

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
VIP: 400 × $50 = $20,000
Regular: 600 × $20 = $12,000
Sponsors: $6,000
Total revenue = $38,000
```

4 Costs and profit

3 min

SAY

"And on the cost side?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT COSTS.

- $3 commission to PR affiliates for each ticket sold
- DJ: $6,000
- Venue rent: $5,000
- Maintenance and insurance: $4,000
- Operational expenses: $4,200

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Separates fixed ($19,200) from per-ticket ($3 × 1,000 = $3,000)
- [ ] Total costs $22,200
- [ ] Profit $15,800
- [ ] Says it's profitable, and by how much (≈42% margin)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Fixed: 6,000 + 5,000 + 4,000 + 4,200 = $19,200
Commission: $3 × 1,000 = $3,000
Costs = $22,200 → Profit = $15,800
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many tickets are sold in total?"

5 Beyond the numbers

3 min

SAY

"This seems profitable. What other aspects of the event do we need to address?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Licenses / permits and local regulations (may need a local partner)
- [ ] Local culture and audience preferences
- [ ] How to sell all tickets: online, stores, social media, timing
- [ ] Extra income: merchandise, food and drinks, parking

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Look for at least 3 of the 4 groups above. Bonus: noting the profit assumes a full sell-out, so selling tickets is the biggest risk.

6 Close

1 min

SAY

"So, should they do it?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] "Yes" first, with the $15.8k profit
- [ ] Biggest risk: selling enough tickets
- [ ] Next steps: permits, early ticket sales, add food and merch

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 4 OF 10

Billionaire Banker

Market entry | Easy | ~15 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A rich person with no banking experience wants to get into Saudi banking. The candidate compares starting a new bank vs. buying an existing one.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

New bank: payback **6.8 years**. Buy existing bank: **8 years**. The right answer is "**it depends on how much risk the client accepts**": building is faster on paper but riskier.

1 Read the prompt

1–2 min

SAY

"Your client is a billionaire considering entering the Saudi banking sector. Should they do it or not? What factors should be considered?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Does the client have banking experience?	"No, no past experience in banking."
How competitive is the market?	"Fairly saturated, but there's still room for a new player like our client."
Any regulations stopping them?	"No new regulations prevent entry. Saudization should be considered, though. (That's the requirement to employ Saudi nationals.)"
What's the client's goal?	"Good question. Keep it in mind."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks about the client's experience
- [ ] Asks about competition and regulation
- [ ] Asks about the client's goal (returns? timeline?)

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"What factors would you look at?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Competitors: who, how strong
- [ ] Barriers to entry: laws, Saudization, local partner
- [ ] Market size and the share we could win
- [ ] Mentions ways to enter: build vs. buy

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What could make it hard to get into this market?"
2. "How could the client actually get into banking?"

3 Two ways in

3–4 min

SAY

"There are two ways to enter. Here are the numbers. Which one pays back faster?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: READ IMMEDIATELY WITH THE QUESTION.

Option 1: open a new bank	Option 2: buy an existing bank
Initial investment: $15M	Cost to buy: $20M
Yearly revenue: $10M	Yearly profit: $2.5M
Profit margin: 22%	

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Option 1 profit = $10M × 22% = $2.2M
- [ ] Option 1 payback ≈ 6.8 years
- [ ] Option 2 payback = 8 years

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Option 1: 15 ÷ 2.2 ≈ 6.8 years
Option 2: 20 ÷ 2.5 = 8 years
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What's the yearly profit of Option 1?"
2. "Payback is investment divided by yearly profit."

4 Push back

2 min

SAY

"So Option 1 is better, right?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Doesn't just agree
- [ ] Building is riskier: no experience, no customers, $10M is only a forecast
- [ ] Buying brings customers and proven profit
- [ ] Says it depends on the client's risk appetite

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

This is the real test. A strong candidate says "not necessarily" and explains risk.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How sure are we of the $10M revenue for a brand-new bank?"

5 Close

1 min

SAY

"What's your recommendation?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Clear answer: enter, and which option depending on risk
- [ ] Mentions Saudization / local partner

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 5 OF 10

TV Family Business

Market entry | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Dubai family business wants to buy a TV channel. They want their money back within 5 years. The candidate calculates whether that happens.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

On paper, 5 years exactly. But that assumes every ad slot is sold. Real revenue is $8M, so payback is **7.5 years**: **it misses the 5-year goal**.

1 Read the prompt

1–2 min

SAY

"Our client is a family business in Dubai that wants to acquire a TV channel broadcasting company. They already own and run businesses in food and drink, and in transportation. Is this a good idea or not?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What's the goal?	"To get their money back in less than 5 years (payback period under 5 years)."
How does the channel make money?	"Advertisements only."
Do they have the money / expertise?	"Yes, assume they do."
Any regulations or barriers?	"No barriers to entry."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks about the client's objective
- [ ] Asks how the channel makes money

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you approach this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Client: money, expertise, conflicts with their other businesses
- [ ] Market: competitors, barriers
- [ ] Profitability: revenue, costs, investment → payback

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

After they explain, steer them: "The client has the capability and there are no barriers. Let's focus on profitability."

3 Maximum ad revenue

4 min

SAY

"Let's focus on profitability. What's the channel's yearly revenue?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK HOW MUCH ADS SELL FOR / HOW THE CHANNEL RUNS.

- Broadcasts 24 hours a day, **300 days** a year
- Each hour: **10 minutes of ads**, 50 minutes of shows
- Peak hours (**4 hours/day**): 1 minute of ads = **$250**
- Other hours (**20 hours/day**): 1 minute of ads = **$100**

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Peak: 250 × 10 × 4 × 300 = $3M
- [ ] Non-peak: 100 × 10 × 20 × 300 = $6M
- [ ] Total $9M per year

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Peak: $250 × 10 × 4 × 300 = $3M
Non-peak: $100 × 10 × 20 × 300 = $6M
Total = $9M per year
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Start with one hour of peak time. How much money is that?"

4 Payback

2 min

SAY

"The purchase costs $15 million. Yearly running costs are $6 million, mostly salaries. What's the payback period?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = 9 − 6 = $3M
- [ ] Payback = 15 ÷ 3 = 5 years

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Profit $3M → payback **5 years**.

5 Does it make sense?

3 min

SAY

"Does that result make sense to you?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: ONCE THEY QUESTION WHETHER ALL ADS SELL (OR AFTER HINT 2).

The channel's actual yearly revenue is **$8 million**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Questions whether every ad slot actually sells
- [ ] Realizes $9M is the maximum, not the real number
- [ ] Recalculates: (8 − 6) = $2M → 7.5 years
- [ ] Says it misses the 5-year goal

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`8 − 6 = $2M profit → 15 ÷ 2 = 7.5 years`

The key insight: **not all ad slots get sold**, so the $9M is a ceiling.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Is every ad minute always sold?"
2. "Is $9M the real revenue or the maximum possible?"

6 Speed it up

3 min

SAY

"How could they increase profit to get their money back faster?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue: sell more ad slots, add subscriptions
- [ ] Advertise their own food and transport businesses on the channel
- [ ] Popular shows to attract viewers and advertisers
- [ ] Costs: cut or outsource staff, automate
- [ ] Negotiate a lower purchase price

7 Close

1 min

SAY

"What's your recommendation to the family?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: not at this price (7.5 vs 5 years)
- [ ] What would change it: lower price (~$10M) or +$1M profit/year

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 6 OF 10

Plane Ticket Price

Profitability | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

An airline wants to know the best price for a Dubai–Paris ticket. Higher prices mean fewer seats sold. The candidate finds the price that makes the most profit. This one is mostly math.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

The best price is **$1,750**. At that price 125 seats sell and profit is about **$146,000**.

1 Read the prompt

1 min

SAY

"Our client is an airline based in Dubai. They're preparing a flight from Dubai to Paris and want us to find the ticket price that maximizes profit."

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How many seats on the plane?	"300 seats."
How does the airline make money on the flight?	"Ticket price, extra luggage, amenities, ads, a fee for minors traveling alone, pet fees. But focus on the ticket price."
What are the costs?	"Food, staff, maintenance, marketing, airport fees, fuel, insurance. I'll give you totals."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks how demand changes with price

2 Approach

2 min

SAY

"How do you want to tackle this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Higher price → fewer seats sold
- [ ] Wants to write profit as a formula of price
- [ ] Plans to find the price where profit is highest

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If you raise the price, what happens to the number of seats sold?"

3 Demand

4 min

SAY

"Here's what we know about demand."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

- At a price of **$1,000**, **200** seats are sold
- At a price of **$2,000**, **100** seats are sold
- Assume a straight-line relationship

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Writes Seats = −0.1 × Price + 300

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Each extra $1,000 loses 100 seats → slope −0.1
Seats = −0.1 × Price + 300
Check: Price $1,000 → 200 seats ✓
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many seats do you lose for each $1,000 increase?"
2. "Try writing seats = a × price + b."

4 Best price

5 min

SAY

"Costs are $10,000 fixed, plus $500 per seat sold. What price maximizes profit?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = $-0.1P^2 + 350P - 160{,}000$
- [ ] Uses calculus (derivative = 0) or the vertex of the curve
- [ ] Gets $1,750

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

$$\text{Revenue} = P \times (-0.1P + 300) = -0.1P^2 + 300P$$
$$\text{Costs} = 10{,}000 + 500 \times (-0.1P + 300) = 160{,}000 - 50P$$
$$\text{Profit} = -0.1P^2 + 350P - 160{,}000$$
$$\text{Best: } -0.2P + 350 = 0 \rightarrow P = \$1{,}750$$

If they test prices instead (e.g. $1,500, $1,750, $2,000) and find $1,750, that's also fine.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Write revenue using price only."
2. "Profit goes up then down. Where's the top?"

5 Close

1–2 min

SAY

"What do you tell the airline?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Price $1,750, sells 125 seats
- [ ] Profit ≈ $146k
- [ ] Notices 175 empty seats: suggests extra fees or different price tiers

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

$$\text{Seats: } -0.1 \times 1{,}750 + 300 = 125$$
$$\text{Revenue: } 1{,}750 \times 125 = \$218{,}750$$
$$\text{Costs: } 10{,}000 + 500 \times 125 = \$72{,}500$$
$$\text{Profit} \approx \$146{,}250$$

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 7 OF 10

Energy Consumption

Discussion | Hard | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Gulf government wants to cut how much energy the country uses. There's no math: the candidate brainstorms in an organized way, sector by sector.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

There's no single number. A strong answer covers **4 sectors** (homes and offices, industry, transport) with **price**, **efficiency** and **behavior** ideas for each.

1 Read the prompt

1 min

SAY

"The ministry of energy of a Gulf country has hired you to design a program to reduce the country's overall energy consumption. How do you approach the problem?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Is there a target, like a %?	"No specific target. We want a program."
Do we have data on which sectors use most?	"No numbers for this case. It's a discussion."
Any budget limits?	"Not for now."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks about a target or timeline

2 Framework

3 min

SAY

"How would you structure the program?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Splits by who uses energy: homes, businesses/entertainment, industry, transport
- [ ] Ways to reduce use in each
- [ ] Feasibility (technology, expertise)
- [ ] Costs vs. benefits (incl. cleaner air, CO_2)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

After they explain, say: "To save time, let's skip feasibility and costs. Just give me ideas to reduce consumption, sector by sector."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who uses energy in a country?"

3 Homes, offices, entertainment

3 min

SAY

"To save time, let's skip feasibility and cost. How would you cut energy use in homes, offices and entertainment venues?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Raise electricity price
- [ ] Subsidize efficient appliances
- [ ] Sensors that switch off lights
- [ ] Fewer unnecessary lights
- [ ] Shared / more efficient cooling systems

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

3 or more good ideas = good. Bonus if they group them (price / technology / behavior).

4 Industry

2 min

SAY

"What about industry?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Raise electricity price
- [ ] Taxes or rules for big energy users
- [ ] Subsidize efficient machines
- [ ] Shorter operating hours
- [ ] Reward companies that research energy savings

5 Transport

2 min

SAY

"And transportation?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Raise fuel prices
- [ ] Make cars / licenses more expensive
- [ ] Higher tolls
- [ ] Car-pooling
- [ ] Public transport
- [ ] Electric car charging stations

6 Close

1–2 min

SAY

"Summarize your program for the minister in under a minute."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Organized summary, not a list of 15 ideas
- [ ] Groups ideas: price, efficiency, behavior
- [ ] Next step: measure which sector uses most, start there

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 8 OF 10

KSA Retail Bank

Profitability | Hard | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A big Saudi bank's revenue has been falling for 2 years. The candidate finds which part of the business is shrinking, then sizes a fix: selling credit cards to customers who already have loans.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

The problem is **Category 1** (personal loans and credit cards). Fix: cross-selling, worth **$5.25M** one way and **$24M total** both ways.

1 Read the prompt + give the data

2 min

SAY

"Our client is one of the largest retail banks in Saudi Arabia. Their revenues have been declining for the past two years. They've hired us to find the reason and give them a solution."

"Here's how their revenue is split."

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How much did revenue drop?	"We don't have the exact figure. Work with the split."
Are competitors affected too?	"Put that in your framework."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY, WITH THE PROMPT. (IN THIS CASE THE DATA COMES FIRST.)

	Cat. 1: Personal loans and credit cards	Cat. 2: Car loans	Cat. 3: House l
2 years ago	55%	28%	17%
Now	50%	30%	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Notices the percentages are shares of a shrinking total

2 Framework

3 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] External: economy, interest rates, regulations, competitors
- [ ] Internal: revenue streams, prices/fees, number of customers, product mix

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

After they explain, say: "The problem is only internal."

3 Find the problem

3 min

SAY

"The problem is only internal. Which category is causing the decline? And what can you say about the other two?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Category 1: its share fell AND the total fell, so it definitely shrank
- [ ] Categories 2 and 3: can't tell. Bigger share of a smaller total could go either way

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The trap: thinking 2 and 3 grew. They only grew as a **share**. Without the total, we can't know.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If the total shrank, did Category 1 shrink in dollars?"
2. "Car loans went from 28% to 30%, but of a smaller total. Did they grow?"

4 How to grow Category 1

3 min

SAY

"How could the bank grow Category 1? Is it easier to sell more to current customers, or to win new ones?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Current customers are easier: people rarely switch banks
- [ ] Mentions cross-selling: credit cards to loan customers and the reverse

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Then say: "Let's size one idea: selling credit cards to customers who only have a personal loan."

5 Size the cross-sell

5–6 min

SAY

"Let's size selling credit cards to customers who only have a personal loan. How much yearly revenue would that add?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY, WITH THE QUESTION.

- 500,000 customers in Category 1: **30%** personal loans only, **50%** credit cards only, **20%** both
- Only **10%** of loan-only customers are interested in a card
- Each customer spends **$20,000** a year on average
- **5%** of customers miss their card payments (default)
- Card fees: **$250** per year, plus a **10%** charge for customers who default

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Loan-only = 150,000 → interested = 15,000
- [ ] Annual fees = $3.75M
- [ ] Default charges = 15,000 × 5% × $20,000 × 10% = $1.5M
- [ ] Total = $5.25M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
15,000 × $250 = $3.75M
15,000 × 5% × $20,000 × 10% = $1.5M
Total = $5.25M per year
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many customers have only a personal loan?"
2. "There are two fees. Do them one at a time."

6 Close

2 min

SAY

"Selling loans to card holders brings another $18.75 million. What's the total, and what do you recommend?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Total = $24M
- [ ] Recommends cross-selling both ways
- [ ] Says to also investigate Categories 2 and 3

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 9 OF 10

Lebanese Cryptocurrency

Market entry | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A startup wants to launch a digital currency for Lebanon. The candidate estimates how many people would use it and how much money it makes.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

About **240,000 users**, **624,000 transactions a week**, and **$61,200 profit per week** (≈ $3.2M a year).

1 Read the prompt

1–2 min

SAY

"Our client is a startup that wants to create a cryptocurrency to be used in Lebanon. They've hired you to find out if this is a good idea."

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Does the client have the skills / money?	"Yes, they have the expertise and the funding."
Who are the competitors?	"One major competitor: Bitcoin, with 60% of the market. The other 40% is up for grabs."
How does the coin make money?	"Transaction fees. I'll give you details later."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks about competition
- [ ] Asks how the coin makes money

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"What's your framework?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Client: skills, money
- [ ] Market: size, competitors, legal barriers
- [ ] Profitability: revenue (fees × transactions) and costs

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

After they explain, say: "The client has the expertise and money, and Bitcoin has 60%. Let's estimate the market."

3 How many users?

4 min

SAY

"Estimate the crypto market in Lebanon. How many people could use our coin?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT POPULATION OR WHO USES CRYPTO.

Lebanon has about **6 million** people, spread evenly from age 0 to 80.

Age	0–20	21–40	41–60	61–80
% into crypto	10%	25%	5%	0%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 1.5M people per age group
- [ ] 150k + 375k + 75k = 600k into crypto
- [ ] × 40% open market = 240k users

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

600k into crypto × 40% = **`240,000 potential users`**.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many people are in each age group?"
2. "Bitcoin holds 60%. How much is left for us?"

4 Transactions

3 min

SAY

"How many transactions per week would they make?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT USAGE OR INCOME.

Income level	% of people	Transactions per week
High	10%	7
Medium	50%	3
Low	40%	1

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 168k + 360k + 96k
- [ ] = 624,000 transactions per week

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
240k × 10% × 7 = 168k
240k × 50% × 3 = 360k
240k × 40% × 1 = 96k
Total = 624k per week
```

5 Profit

4 min

SAY

"Here's how the coin charges. What's the weekly profit?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

- A fixed charge of **$0.50** on every transaction
- Plus a commission:

Transaction size	Commission	% of transactions
$0–10k	$0.60	50%
$10k–100k	$0.40	40%
Over $100k	$0.20	10%

- Profit margin: **10%**

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Fixed fees = $312k
- [ ] Average commission $0.48 → ≈ $300k
- [ ] Revenue ≈ $612k per week
- [ ] Profit = 10% ≈ $61,200 per week

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
$0.50 × 624k = $312k
(0.5×0.60 + 0.4×0.40 + 0.1×0.20) = $0.48 × 624k ≈ $300k
Revenue ≈ $612k → Profit ≈ $61.2k per week
```

6 Why only 10%?

2 min

SAY

"Why do you think the profit margin is only 10%?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Expensive setup: licenses, servers, cooling
- [ ] Cost of processing transactions on the blockchain
- [ ] Expensive to win users away from Bitcoin

7 Close

1 min

SAY

"What's your recommendation?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Looks profitable: ~$61k/week (~$3.2M/year)
- [ ] Risk: new competitors shrink our 40%
- [ ] Next: compare setup cost with profit (payback), and cut costs

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 10 OF 10

Hair Loss Pill

Profitability | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A company invented a single pill that cures hair loss. The candidate sets a price and estimates first-year revenue in Lebanon.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Price around **$7,500** (1.5–2× a hair transplant). About 220,000 people can afford it, 20% buy in year one → **$330 million**.

1 Read the prompt

1–2 min

SAY

"Our client has created a pill that reverses hair loss. They want to sell it in Lebanon and have hired you to estimate the first year's revenue."

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How many pills does someone need?	"Just one pill cures a person."
Any competitors?	"No direct competitors. But hair treatments and transplants compete on price."
What do alternatives cost?	"A hair transplant costs about $5,000 on average."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks how many pills are needed
- [ ] Asks about alternatives / competitors

2 Framework

2 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue = price × number of buyers
- [ ] Price: based on value, cost, or competitors
- [ ] Buyers: how many people have hair loss, who can afford it

3 Price

3 min

SAY

"Let's start with price. What would you charge for one pill, and why?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Compares to the $5,000 transplant
- [ ] Argues one pill = lifetime cure = high value
- [ ] Lands around $7,500–$10,000

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Expected range: **$7,500–$10,000** (1.5–2× a transplant). Anything with a clear reason is acceptable. For the rest of the case, say: "Let's use $7,500."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What do people pay today to fix hair loss?"

4 How many interested

4 min

SAY

"Let's use $7,500. Now, how many people in Lebanon would want this pill?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT POPULATION OR WHO SUFFERS FROM HAIR LOSS.

Age	Men	% interested	Women	% interested
0–20	0.75M	0%	0.75M	0%
21–40	0.75M	20%	0.75M	0%
41–60	0.75M	50%	0.75M	5%
61–80	0.75M	40%	0.75M	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Includes women, not just men
- [ ] Men 825k + women 187.5k
- [ ] ≈ 1 million interested (rounds to 1M)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Men: 150k + 375k + 300k = 825k
Women: 37.5k + 150k = 187.5k
Total ≈ 1.01M → round to 1M
```

5 Who can afford it

3 min

SAY

"Can all of them afford it?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY BRING UP INCOME.

Income	% of people	% who can afford it
High	10%	100%
Medium	40%	30%
Low	50%	0%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 100k + 120k = 220,000 can afford it

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
1M × 10% × 100% = 100k
1M × 40% × 30% = 120k
Total = 220k
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Is $7,500 affordable for everyone in Lebanon?"

6 Year-one revenue

3 min

SAY

"Will all 220,000 buy it in the first year?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: ONCE THEY SAY NOT EVERYONE WILL BUY RIGHT AWAY.

Assume **20%** (early adopters) buy in year one.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Says no: only early adopters buy in year one
- [ ] 220k × 20% × $7,500 = $330M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

220k × 20% × $7,500 = **$330 million**

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Do new products get bought by everyone in year one?"

7 Close

2 min

SAY

"$330 million. Is this a profitable idea?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue isn't profit: development costs were likely huge
- [ ] The price might be too high if results equal a transplant
- [ ] Answer is clear and structured

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: — / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

OPTIONAL WARM-UP, 5–10 MINUTES

Fit questions

Real interviews often start with 2–3 personal questions before the case. Ask one or two. Good answers last 1–2 minutes and tell a story.

Ask	A good answer...
"Tell me about yourself."	A 1–2 minute story, not a CV list: studies, 1–2 experiences, why consulting, one personal detail that makes them memorable.
"Why consulting?"	Specific reasons tied to their own experience (problem-solving, variety, learning). Shows they know what the job really is.
"Why our firm?"	Names something specific: people they've met, a program, values. Not just "prestige".
"Give me an example of leadership."	A real situation, what THEY did and why, the result, and what they learned. Admits a shortcoming.
"What are your three biggest weaknesses?"	Real weaknesses, not humble-brags, each with what they're doing to improve.
"Tell me about a time you challenged yourself."	A clear challenge, the steps they took, the outcome.
"Why should we give you an offer?"	2–3 confident reasons linked to what consultants actually do.
"Why aren't you working in the field of your major?"	A positive story about moving toward consulting, not running away from their major.

Red flags in fit answers

- Over 2 minutes long
- Sounds memorized word for word
- Lists facts from the CV with no story
- Can't say why consulting specifically